

Chapter 32-1

[After filming, come find me at the hotel.]

After Yan Si sent this message, she placed her phone face-down on the table.

In the spacious hotel room, sounds echoed - it was Yan Si's fingers tapping against the table surface.

She now didn't want to have too much contact with Si Xin, nor did she want to go to Si Xin's home, so she decided to simply resolve the matter at the hotel.

Si Xin saw the message Yan Si sent, saw the hotel room number, and the excitement in her heart couldn't be suppressed.

Just at this moment, the little assistant came back.

Si Xin glanced at her, "I have something to do now. Don't follow me."

After saying this, Si Xin didn't care about the change in the little assistant's expression and drove her out the door.

She took off the film crew's clothes and changed into a red dress that exposed her back, carefully drawing exquisite makeup on her face.

Looking at her excellent image in the mirror, her mood at this moment was extremely good.

Her first meeting with Yan Si was on a film set. At that time, Yan Si was playing the female lead, while she was just a background extra - the kind that appeared on screen for less than three seconds.

Near evening, the film crew wrapped up, and her scenes were also finished.

She had begged the editing staff at that time to let her appear on screen for a few more seconds, but was refused.

Feeling confused about her future, she suddenly started crying.

It was at that moment that Yan Si approached her. Yan Si said that as long as she accompanied her in acting out a scene in reality, that would be enough.

Hearing Yan Si say this, her tears stopped immediately.

She knew that once she latched onto Yan Si, her resources would definitely be smooth sailing.

In the hotel, Yan Si's fingertips tapped the table surface with increasing frequency, not knowing how to explain to Yin Lingzhu.

Just as she was worrying, she heard the hotel door being knocked.

She was still somewhat puzzled - Si Xin shouldn't come at this time.

Looking through the peephole, she opened the door with some surprise.

"Aren't you filming? How did you get here so early?" Yan Si opened the door.

Seeing that it was indeed Yan Si herself in the hotel, Si Xin couldn't hide the joy in her voice, "I wanted to see you earlier."

After she came in, Yan Si carefully closed the door.

In an unnoticed corner, a weak light flickered on but immediately went out.

Yan Si sat on the sofa, "The message you sent to Lingzhu today - what did it mean?"

Hearing that Yan Si had come because of this matter, Si Xin's eyes showed a flash of panic, but she quickly covered it up.

"President Yan, I missed you," Si Xin wanted to act coquettish.

A hint of disgust appeared on Yan Si's face, "Speak properly."

"Besides, what I said wasn't wrong either. Even if you married her, someone like you, with your status - she shouldn't be controlling you."

Si Xin spoke as if it was natural, feeling nothing was wrong with what she said.

She even thought she was speaking Yan Si's inner thoughts.

"Si Xin, listen carefully to what I'm saying now."

"I willingly let her control me, understand?"

Yan Si's tone was relaxed, but Si Xin broke out in cold sweat listening to her.

"If you cause trouble for Lingzhu again in the future, I'll let you know what true blacklisting¹ means."

"I can build myself up, and I can make you sink into the depths."

"Even if you're popular now, I can make you disappear without you even noticing."

Though she was unwilling now, she didn't dare say anything and could only nod.

She had originally wanted to use Yan Si to improve her resources, but hadn't expected it to backfire and make Yan Si detest her.

But Si Xin wasn't afraid now. Recently, someone had approached her - though that person wasn't in the entertainment industry, their status was not to be underestimated.

Si Xin nodded, her tone cautious, "Alright, President Yan."

Yan Si glanced at her, satisfied with her understanding of the situation.

"Good that you understand. In the future..."

Yan Si paused and changed what she was originally going to say.

"You need to apologize to Lingzhu. If Lingzhu doesn't mind, then fine. If she's angry, you know the consequences."

Si Xin nodded somewhat humiliatingly, her expression caught by Yan Si's eyes.

"Unwilling?" Yan Si's tone was light, but Si Xin's heart skipped a beat.

"No, no, no, I'm very willing." Si Xin's head shook like a rattle drum², and she put on a fawning smile.

Yan Si stood up, suddenly remembering how quickly Si Xin had arrived today, "What drama are you filming now?"

Si Xin immediately picked up on Yan Si's question, "It's Director Zheng's, and this drama was given to me by you."

Director Zheng - Yan Si knew this person. He was quite a responsible director, and the TV dramas he produced were all quite good.

"Director Zheng would agree to let you take leave?"

In Yan Si's memory, she had also worked with Director Zheng before.

Outside of filming, Director Zheng always had a smiling demeanor, but once filming started, he couldn't tolerate any grain of sand in his eyes³.

Si Xin hadn't expected her to ask this. She knew Yan Si's serious attitude toward filming, "Director Zheng is very easygoing."

Yan Si was a bit puzzled, but she hadn't worked with Director Zheng for a long time.

It was possible that Director Zheng's personality had changed.

Just as she was about to leave, she received a text message from Director Zheng.

[President Yan, the actress Si Xin you recommended - I can't afford to use her now.]

Seeing this text message, Yan Si understood in her heart, her eyes full of mockery, "Si Xin, you really are something."

Seeing her look at the text message and then ask this question, Si Xin cursed Director Zheng in her heart for being troublesome.

"I had my assistant ask for leave. Perhaps she didn't explain it properly to Director Zheng."

Si Xin put on an obedient appearance, acting as if she knew nothing about it.

"Mm, you're playing the female lead in this drama, right?" Yan Si asked.

"Yes." Si Xin nodded obediently, thinking in her heart whether Yan Si was going to give her another resource.

While Si Xin was thinking, she heard Yan Si say, "You're not going to act in this drama anymore."

Si Xin was stunned immediately. She couldn't believe her own ears.

"President Yan, what did you say?" she asked incredulously.

"But I'm the female protagonist. We've already filmed for a while. If we change actors now, wouldn't that be problematic?"

Si Xin said anxiously. From Yan Si's tone, she was going to withdraw her resources.

Therefore, her tone became urgent.

Hearing the rebuttal, Yan Si spoke with a half-smile, "I gave you this drama, so I have the right to take it back at any time. You can only accept, not question. Understand?"

Hearing her say this, Si Xin's face went pale. She still wanted to defend herself, but Yan Si interrupted her.

"Enough. You know very well what you've done." Yan Si said impatiently.

"If you bother me again, I'll make you disappear from the entertainment industry right now."

Yan Si's voice carried an icy chill. Her merciless appearance left Si Xin unable to say anything.

Seeing Yan Si about to leave, Si Xin made way for her.

This time, she had miscalculated. She had thought Yan Si had some feelings for her, but hadn't expected Yan Si to be so heartless.

A sinister gleam flashed in Si Xin's eyes.

Footnotes:

¹ Blacklisting: In the Chinese entertainment industry, this refers to the practice of completely banning someone from getting work, essentially ending their career through industry-wide boycott.

² Rattle drum: A traditional Chinese toy drum with beads attached that make noise when the drum is shaken rapidly back and forth, similar to how Si Xin was shaking her head.

³ Couldn't tolerate any grain of sand in his eyes: A Chinese idiom meaning someone who is extremely strict and won't tolerate even the smallest mistakes or unprofessional behavior.